

MEMORIES, THOUGHTS, AND EMOTIONS

MANY MENTAL FACULTIES ARE NOT CONTROLLED BY JUST ONE AREA OF THE BRAIN. FOR EXAMPLE, THERE IS NO SINGLE "MEMORY CENTRE". THOUGHTS, FEELINGS, EMOTIONS, AWARENESS, AND MEMORY INVOLVE MANY PARTS OF THE BRAIN.

MAP OF THE CORTEX

Certain regions of the brain's cortex are called primary sensory areas. Each of these receives sensory information from a specific sense. The primary visual cortex, for instance, analyses data from the eyes. Around each region are association areas, where data from the specific sense is integrated with data from other senses, compared with memories and knowledge, and associated with feelings and emotions. In this way, seeing a particular scene

allows us to recognize, identify, and name the objects in it, remember where we saw them previously, recall related sensory data, such as a certain smell, and experience associated emotions again.

CENTRES OF ACTIVITY

Certain areas of the cortex carry out specific brain functions, while others are more generalized. No areas have been identified as exact sites of consciousness or learning.

